Chapter 2.—ELECTIVE FRANCHISE

Sec.
31. Race, color, or previous condition not to affect right to vote.
32. Interference with freedom of elections.

§ 31. Race, color, or previous condition not to affect right to vote.

All citizens of the United States who are otherwise qualified by law to vote at any election by the people in any State, Territory, district, county, city, parish, township, school district, municipality, or other territorial subdivision, shall be entitled and allowed to vote at all such elections, without distinction of race, color, or previous condition of servitude; any constitution, law, custom, usage, or regulation of any State or Territory, or by or under its authority, to the contrary notwithstanding. (R. S. § 2004.)

DERIVATION

Act May 31, 1870, ch. 114, § 1, 16 Stat. 140.

§ 32. Interference with freedom of elections.

No officer of the Army or Navy of the United States shall prescribe or fix, or attempt to prescribe or fix, by proclamation, order, or otherwise, the qualifications of voters in any State, or in any manner interfere with the freedom of any election in any State, or with the exercise of the free right of suffrage in any State. (R. S. § 2003.)

DERIVATION

Act Feb. 25, 1865, ch. 52, § 1, 13 Stat. 437.

Chapter 3.—CIVIL RIGHTS

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41. Equal rights under the law.
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51. Marshal to obey precepts; refusing to receive or execute process.
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53. Same; persons appointed to execute process.
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§ 41. Equal rights under the law.

All persons within the jurisdiction of the United States shall have the same right in every State and Territory to make and enforce contracts, to sue, be parties, give evidence, and to the full and equal benefit of all laws and proceedings for the security of persons and property as is enjoyed by white citizens, and shall be subject to like punishment, pains, penalties, taxes, licenses, and exactions of every kind, and to no other. (R. S. § 1977.)

DERIVATION

Act May 31, 1870, ch. 114, § 16, 16 Stat. 144.

§ 42. Property rights of citizens.

All citizens of the United States shall have the same right, in every State and Territory, as is enjoyed by white citizens thereof to inherit, purchase, lease, sell, hold, and convey real and personal property. (R. S. § 1978.)

DERIVATION

Act Apr. 9, 1866, ch. 31, § 1, 14 Stat. 27.

§ 43. Civil action for deprivation of rights.

Every person who, under color of any statute, ordinance, regulation, custom, or usage, of any State or Territory, subjects, or causes to be subjected, any citizen of the United States or other person within the jurisdiction thereof to the deprivation of any rights, privileges, or immunities secured by the Constitution and laws, shall be liable to the party injured in an action at law, suit in equity, or other proper proceeding for redress. (R. S. § 1979.)

DERIVATION

Act Apr. 20, 1871, ch. 22, § 1, 17 Stat. 13.

§ 44. Exclusion of jurors on account of race or color.

No citizen possessing all other qualifications which are or may be prescribed by law shall be disqualified for service as grand or petit juror in any court of the United States, or of any State on account of race, color, or previous condition of servitude; and any officer or other person charged with any duty in the selection or summoning of jurors who shall exclude or fail to summon any citizen for the cause aforesaid shall, on conviction thereof, be deemed guilty of a misdemeanor, and be fined not more than $5,000. (Mar. 1, 1875, ch. 114, § 4, 18 Stat. 336.)

§ 45. Same; prosecution of violations.

The district courts of the United States shall have, exclusively of the courts of the several States, cognizance of all crimes and offenses against and violations of, the provisions of section 44 of this title. The district attorneys, marshals, and deputy marshals of the United States, and United States commissioners with powers of arresting and imprisoning or bailing offenders against the laws of the United States, are hereby specially authorized and required to institute proceedings against every person who shall violate the provisions of section 44 of this title, and cause him to be arrested and imprisoned or bailed, as the case may be, for trial before such court of the United States, or Territorial court, as by law has cognizance of the offense, and such district attorneys shall cause such proceedings to be prosecuted to their termination as in other cases. Nothing contained in this section shall be construed to deny or defeat any right of civil action accruing to any person, whether by reason of this act or otherwise; and any district attorney who shall willfully fail to institute and prosecute the proceedings herein required, shall, for every such offense, forfeit and pay the sum of $500 to the person aggrieved thereby, to be recovered by an action of debt, with full costs, and shall, on conviction thereof, be deemed guilty of a misdemeanor, and be fined not less than $1,000 nor more than $5,000. Judgment for the penalty in favor of the party aggrieved against any such